Meister at Archimedes.”

“Why?”

“So that you will receive special privileges.”

“But I already do, compared to the Polish workers.”

“The Poles are dirty swine. Of course you are at a higher level.” Something dark passed across his face. “You will see what I have in mind.”

Looking down, she tried to hide how his words made her recoil. “Thank you for the offer,” she said, swallowing. “But it’s not necessary.”

“Are *you* telling me what to do?”

“Oh, no. It’s only that I don’t want to trouble you.” She bit her lip, wondering what had happened to the man sitting with her on the bench from a moment ago, grieving for his brother. “I’d be very grateful for whatever you do on my behalf.”

“That’s the correct attitude.” He handed the permit back to her.

“Thank you,” she said, a chill running down her spine. Suddenly, it felt like the church walls had dissolved, and she was back outside on the cold, dark street.

“We shall certainly see one another again,” he said, standing and knocking his leather boots against one another. He extended his right arm straight out from the shoulder. “Heil Hitler!”

Every part of Rose filled with disgust, but she knew what was expected and that if she failed to return the salute, he could cause trouble not only for her but possibly for Léa. It wouldn’t take him long to know everything about her. She stood and raised her right arm straight out. “Heil Hitler.”

He smiled, signaling his approval, then turned and left. The church door shut with a clanging sound.

Rose collapsed on the pew, the candle breaking in her hand.